

Zaakirah *Dawood-Hawa*

MARKETING LEAD · BRAND & COMMUNICATIONS

BASE Calgary, AB, Canada

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6+ YEARS OF
EXPERIENCE

4 INDUSTRIES,
END TO END

2 CONTINENTS
CALLED HOME

35+ TOOLS IN
THE KIT

PROFILE

A marketing leader who takes brands from blank page to shipped. Most recently built a 40-year software firm's entire brand presence in a single year — **identity system, website, and a full product launch** — as the owner of its marketing function. Six years across property, financial services, AI, and B2B software on two continents. Combines a designer's craft, a project manager's discipline, and a rare credential — **a year spent professionally training and evaluating AI models** — to ship more, faster, without sacrificing polish. Known for turning chaotic workflows into systems that outlast her tenure.

Brand strategy & identity

End-to-end campaign management

Copywriting & content

Web & creative design

Event production

Marketing operations

Process & systems design

AI-accelerated workflows

Stakeholder management

EXPERIENCE

Marketing Lead

2025 — 2026

SES Inc. — Strategic Estimating Software

Calgary, AB

- **Built the company's first complete brand system from a blank page** — logo system, palette, typography, and brand guidelines that now govern every asset a 40-year-old firm produces.
- **Designed, wrote, and shipped the corporate website** (ses-software.com) end to end, translating a technical cost-estimating product suite into positioning that B2B decision-makers act on.
- **Took the QPlant Estimator to market** as a one-person launch team: strategy, presentation decks, a product film, event collateral, and post-event feedback surveys that fed directly into the product roadmap.
- **Unified all print and digital collateral** (brochure, surveys, banners, decks) under a single standard, replacing years of ad-hoc, inconsistent assets.
- Embedded AI tools across the marketing workflow — research, drafting, asset iteration — compressing production timelines while raising output quality.

Advanced AI Data Trainer & Quality Analyst

MAR — NOV 2024

Invisible Technologies

Remote

- **Trained and evaluated production AI models:** designed and stress-tested prompts across diverse use cases to drive accuracy, relevance, and alignment with client goals.
- **Held model output quality to contractual client SLAs** through rigorous assessment protocols, iterative feedback, and refined training procedures.
- Cut recurring error patterns by analyzing failure modes, implementing corrective measures, and validating outputs through structured fact-checking.
- Authored process documentation adopted as the team standard, reducing errors and onboarding time for new analysts.

Communications & CX Manager

JAN 2022 — JUL 2023

Sanlam

South Africa · one of Africa's largest financial-services groups

- **Led campaigns end to end** across email, SMS, social, and events — copy, design, segmentation, and A/B testing — lifting engagement while keeping every asset brand-consistent and compliant.
- **Designed and launched a centralized knowledge hub** with L&D that became the organization's primary onboarding tool, cutting training time for new client-facing hires and eliminating repeat queries to senior staff.
- **Replaced a fragmented email request system with a structured Jira intake** — standardized briefs and automated status updates that accelerated delivery and ended lost requests.
- Produced corporate events end to end (product launches, HR initiatives, townhalls): budget, vendors, logistics, and the attendee experience.
- Grew LinkedIn and community-forum engagement through a targeted content strategy and active community management.
- Audited and redesigned the firm's bilingual (English/Afrikaans) client forms to brand and regulatory standards, partnering with engineers on a version-tracking dashboard that de-risked audits.

Portfolio Coordinator

JAN 2019 — JUN 2021

SAPIN

South Africa

- **Managed end-to-end property projects** — renovations, tenant-acquisition campaigns, and marketing — holding budgets and timelines across concurrent projects.
- **Negotiated contracts** with contractors, vendors, and financial institutions, optimizing costs without compromising quality.
- Built risk-assessment frameworks and financial models that guided portfolio decisions and compliance.
- Designed tenant retention and acquisition campaigns that improved occupancy and brand visibility.

TOOLKIT

AI

ChatGPT · Gemini · Perplexity · DeepSeek · Adobe Firefly — plus professional model-training experience

Design & content

Adobe Creative Suite · Figma · Canva · DaVinci Resolve · CapCut · WordPress · Weebly

Operations

Jira · Trello · Notion · Google Suite · Excel · SharePoint · CRM · Slack · Teams

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Commerce, Financial Accounting

University of the Western Cape

Google Project Management Certificate

Coursera

Financial Markets Practitioner

South African Institute of Stockbrokers (SAIS)

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Work samples & case studies: zaakirahdawoodhawa.github.io